

overthinking and coming up with backup strategies. This can work for or against me, as you'll see below.

When I'm stressed, I tend to do three things. First, I come up with new ideas, new revenue streams for my businesses or ideas around how we could blow up what we're currently doing, and I throw myself into that, using the basement behaviours of my hybrid Discerner and Worker Money Types. I spend countless hours (seven days a week) planning, strategising and, in the past, spending way too much time and money chasing some of these ideas. Now, I'm not saying it's bad to chase ideas, but when you're overspending simply to try to regain control over a situation, it's not good. Especially for your finances.

The second thing I do is to slam the brakes on managing my personal finances (spending excepted). It's almost as though I'm so busy in my business coming up with new ventures and overspending on them that that I can justify pressing 'Pause' on my personal finances. And really by pause I mean I press 'Stop'. I'm late on my tax returns (not good for an accountant), I can't deal with the small things and I can't make purchasing decisions around investment assets that I've already decided will be right to buy. During this time, I become so incredibly frustrated at myself that I overcompensate by working on even more ideas, and the cycle continues. Interestingly, I also usually stop exercising and meditating here and start binge-eating chocolate by the fistful.

However, the third thing I do in this cycle could be the most damaging if those new ventures from step one aren't successful (which thankfully most are): I spend personally. It's at this point that I'm making the most of my VIP status at Net-a-Porter because I'm busy, I'm harried, I'm exhausted and I'm not seeing any immediate rewards with things I've planned personally, so I figure I may as well see rewards come in the forms of pretty things delivered via courier. By now, my default spending is often in conflict with my values around sustainability and ethical consumption so shame kicks in. And the cycle continues.

Stress and how I manage it has the power to derail me financially if I'm not careful but, if I'm honest, it also has the capacity to derail me physically and mentally. And has in the past. Because I'm avoiding what's really going on for me and throwing bandaids on gaping wounds through all this frenetic activity.